

The Biblical Story Through Its People

A Character-and-Story Student Workbook

PLANTED YOUTH

Millheim Baptist Church

Introduction

The Bible tells one connected history through real people and events. These lessons follow the major characters and stories from Lucifer's rebellion and Adam's fall through Israel's patriarchs, kings, and prophets; Jesus Christ and His apostles; the Church's mission; and Christ's return and eternal kingdom.

Read the listed passages, complete each NOTE, and use the editable charts to connect each person and event with the whole story.

All Scripture quotations are from the King James Version. Prepared for PLANTED YOUTH at Millheim Baptist Church.

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UNIT 1 — REBELLION, RECONSTRUCTION, AND THE FIRST WORLD

Lesson 1 — Lucifer: The First Rebel and the Ruined Earth

Lesson Overview: The Bible's story begins with God, His original creation, and a created cherub who becomes proud. Lucifer's rebellion brings judgment and darkness; God then speaks light, order, and life into the ruined earth.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 1:1–2:3; Job 38:4–7; Isaiah 14:12–15; Ezekiel 28:12–19; Isaiah 45:18

KEY VERSE | Ezekiel 28:15 — *Thou wast perfect in thy ways from the day that thou wast created, till iniquity was found in thee.*

READ: Genesis 1:1–2:3; Job 38:4–7; Isaiah 14:12–15; 45:18; Ezekiel 28:12–19; John 1:1–5; Revelation 12:7–12.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
God creates the heaven and the earth	Genesis 1:1 — ***"In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth."***
The heavenly host rejoices	Job 38:4–7 describes the morning stars singing and the sons of God shouting at the earth's foundation.
Pride rises in Lucifer	Isaiah 14:12–15 records his five proud ***"I will"*** statements.
Iniquity is found in the cherub	Ezekiel 28:12–17 describes beauty, wisdom, pride, and corruption.

Story movement	Scripture
The earth lies under darkness	Genesis 1:2; compare Isaiah 45:18 and Jeremiah 4:23–26.
God begins reconstruction	Genesis 1:3 — ***"And God said, Let there be light: and there was light."***

1. Lucifer's Position, Pride, and Fall

Lucifer is a created being, not God's equal. Ezekiel describes an anointed cherub who was perfect until iniquity was found in him. Isaiah records his desire to exalt his throne and be like the most High.

His rebellion establishes the conflict that runs through Scripture: God moves history toward His purpose, while Satan opposes God's Word, people, land, and promised King.

Lucifer's Fall

Stage	What Scripture shows	Passages
Created	Perfect in his ways; wise, beautiful, and appointed as an anointed cherub	Ezekiel 28:12–15
Proud	His heart is lifted up because of beauty	Ezekiel 28:17
Rebellious	He seeks a higher throne and God's place	Isaiah 14:12–14
Cast down	God announces humiliation and judgment	Isaiah 14:15; Ezekiel 28:16–19
Still opposing	He deceives, accuses, and fights until his final judgment	Genesis 3; Revelation 12:9–12; 20:10

NOTE — Lucifer was a created _____, not God's equal.

NOTE — Pride led Lucifer to seek God's _____.

2. God Reconstructs the Earth

Genesis 1:1 records God's original creation. Genesis 1:2 shows the earth without form, void, and covered by darkness and the deep. Beginning in verse 3, God speaks order into the earth and prepares it for mankind.

The Days of Reconstruction

Day	God's work	Scripture
1	Light divided from darkness	Genesis 1:3–5
2	Firmament divides the waters	Genesis 1:6–8
3	Dry land, seas, grass, herbs, and fruit trees	Genesis 1:9–13
4	Sun, moon, and stars appointed	Genesis 1:14–19
5	Sea creatures and flying creatures	Genesis 1:20–23
6	Land animals; man and woman	Genesis 1:24–31; 2:7, 18–25
7	God rests from His finished work	Genesis 2:1–3

NOTE — God began reconstruction by commanding _____.

NOTE — On the sixth day God made man in His image and _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. What does Scripture reveal about Lucifer before his rebellion?
2. What five proud desires appear in Isaiah 14:12–14?
3. How does Satan oppose God's purpose throughout the Bible?
4. What condition does Genesis 1:2 describe?
5. List the days of reconstruction and their passages.

UNIT 1 — REBELLION, RECONSTRUCTION, AND THE FIRST WORLD

Lesson 2 — Adam and Eve: Eden, the Fall, and the Promised Seed

Lesson Overview: God places Adam and Eve in Eden with life, fellowship, work, marriage, and dominion. The serpent attacks God's Word; Adam disobeys; sin and death enter; and God promises the Seed who will defeat the serpent.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 1:26–31; Genesis 2–3; Romans 5:12–21; 1 Timothy 2:13–14; Revelation 12:9

KEY VERSE | Genesis 3:15 — *And I will put enmity between thee and the woman, and between thy seed and her seed; it shall bruise thy head, and thou shalt bruise his heel.*

READ: Genesis 1:26–31; 2:7–25; 3:1–24; Romans 5:12–21; 1 Corinthians 15:21–22, 45–49; 1 Timothy 2:13–14; Revelation 12:9.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
God forms Adam	Genesis 2:7 — God forms man from dust and breathes into him the breath of life.
God forms Eve	Genesis 2:18–25 — God makes a help meet for Adam and establishes marriage.
The serpent attacks the Word	Genesis 3:1–5 — he questions, contradicts, and changes God's command.
Adam and Eve eat	Genesis 3:6–7 — shame and separation immediately follow.

Story movement	Scripture
God pronounces judgment	Genesis 3:14–19 — the serpent, woman, man, and ground are addressed.
God promises the Seed	Genesis 3:15 points forward to the serpent's defeat.

1. Life in Eden

Adam is made in God's image and likeness and receives dominion under God. God gives him work, a clear command, and a wife. Marriage begins as one man and one woman joined by God.

> **Genesis 2:16–17 —** *Of every tree of the garden thou mayest freely eat: But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it…*

NOTE — God placed Adam in the garden to dress it and _____ it.

NOTE — Eve was made as an help _____ for Adam.

2. The First Attack on God's Word

The devil's first recorded attack is directed at God's words. Eve is deceived, but Adam knowingly transgresses. Their choice brings sin, death, shame, toil, and separation into the human story.

The Serpent's Strategy

Attack	Words or action	What changed
Questions	***"Yea, hath God said…?"*** (Genesis 3:1)	Doubt is introduced.
Contradicts	***"Ye shall not surely die"*** (Genesis 3:4)	God's warning is denied.

Attack	Words or action	What changed
Changes	Disobedience is presented as advancement (Genesis 3:5)	A false promise replaces God's truth.
Eve adds	***"neither shall ye touch it"*** (Genesis 3:3)	Words not in Genesis 2:16–17 are added.

NOTE — Satan questions, contradicts, and changes the Word of _____.

NOTE — Through one man, sin and _____ entered the world.

3. Judgment and the First Promise

God seeks the guilty pair, exposes their sin, and pronounces judgment. Yet judgment is not the last word. The Seed of the woman will be wounded, but He will crush the serpent's head. The rest of the Bible follows this promise toward Jesus Christ.

> **Romans 5:19 —** *For as by one man's disobedience many were made sinners, so by the obedience of one shall many be made righteous.*

NOTE — Genesis 3:15 promises the victorious _____.

NOTE — Jesus Christ is called the last _____ in 1 Corinthians 15:45.

Check Your Understanding

1. What responsibilities did God give Adam in Eden?
2. How did the serpent attack God's Word?
3. How does 1 Timothy 2 distinguish Eve's deception from Adam's transgression?
4. What entered the world through Adam's sin?
5. How does Genesis 3:15 direct the story toward Christ?

UNIT 1 — REBELLION, RECONSTRUCTION, AND THE FIRST WORLD

Lesson 3 — Cain, Abel, Enoch, and Noah: Sin Spreads and God Preserves

Lesson Overview: Outside Eden, sin spreads through Adam's family and fills the earth with violence. Abel worships by faith, Enoch walks with God, and Noah finds grace. God judges the world through the Flood while preserving Noah's household in the ark.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 4–9; Hebrews 11:4–7; Matthew 24:37–39; 1 Peter 3:20; 2 Peter 2:5

KEY VERSE | Genesis 6:8 — *But Noah found grace in the eyes of the LORD.*

READ: Genesis 4:1–16; 5:1–32; 6:1–9:29; Hebrews 11:4–7; Matthew 24:37–39; 1 Peter 3:18–22; 2 Peter 2:5; 3:3–7.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Abel offers by faith	Genesis 4:1–5; Hebrews 11:4.
Cain murders Abel	Genesis 4:6–16 — Cain ignores God's warning that sin lies at the door.
Enoch walks with God	Genesis 5:21–24; Hebrews 11:5–6.
The earth becomes corrupt	Genesis 6:5, 11–13.
Noah builds the ark	Genesis 6:14–22; Hebrews 11:7.

Story movement	Scripture
The Flood judges the world	Genesis 7:1–24.
God gives the rainbow	Genesis 8:20–9:17.

1. Three Men in a Fallen World

Abel approaches God by faith. Cain refuses correction and kills his brother. Enoch walks with God in a wicked generation and is translated. Their stories show that sin spreads, yet individuals can still believe God and walk with Him.

Cain, Abel, and Enoch

Person	Choice	Result	Passages
Abel	Offers to God by faith	Receives witness that he is righteous	Genesis 4:2–5; Hebrews 11:4
Cain	Rejects warning and murders Abel	Is judged and becomes a fugitive	Genesis 4:5–16; 1 John 3:11–12
Enoch	Walks with God by faith	Is translated without seeing death	Genesis 5:21–24; Hebrews 11:5–6; Jude 14–15

NOTE — Abel offered unto God by _____.

NOTE — Enoch walked with _____.

2. Noah, the Ark, and the Flood

The earth becomes corrupt and filled with violence. Noah believes God's warning, builds the ark, and brings his household inside. The Flood judges the old world; the ark preserves the family through whom the human story continues.

Noah's Story

Movement	What happened	Scripture
Grace	Noah finds grace and walks with God	Genesis 6:8–9
Warning	God announces judgment and gives the ark's plan	Genesis 6:11–22
Obedience	Noah enters with his family and the animals	Genesis 7:1–10
Judgment	The Flood covers the earth	Genesis 7:11–24
Preservation	God remembers Noah; the waters recede	Genesis 8:1–19
Covenant	God gives the rainbow sign	Genesis 8:20–9:17

NOTE — Noah found _____ in the eyes of the LORD.

NOTE — The rainbow is the sign of God's covenant with the _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. How did Abel, Cain, and Enoch respond differently to God?
2. What does the repeated phrase “and he died” teach in Genesis 5?
3. Why did God send the Flood?
4. How did Noah demonstrate faith?
5. What did God promise in the Noahic covenant?

UNIT 1 — REBELLION, RECONSTRUCTION, AND THE FIRST WORLD

Lesson 4 — Babel and Abraham: The Nations Scatter and One Man Is Called

Lesson Overview: At Babel mankind unites in pride, builds a city and tower, and seeks its own name. God scatters the nations, then calls Abram from Ur and promises to form a nation through which all families of the earth will be blessed.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 10–12; Genesis 15; Genesis 17; Genesis 22; Galatians 3:6–18

KEY VERSE | Genesis 12:2–3 — *And I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and make thy name great…and in thee shall all families of the earth be blessed.*

READ: Genesis 10:1–32; 11:1–32; 12:1–9; 13:14–18; 15:1–21; 17:1–21; 22:1–18; Romans 4:1–5; Galatians 3:6–18.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Families become nations	Genesis 10 traces the descendants of Shem, Ham, and Japheth.
Men build Babel	Genesis 11:1–4 — they seek a city, tower, and name.
God scatters mankind	Genesis 11:5–9 — languages are confounded.
God calls Abram	Genesis 12:1–3 — land, nation, name, and worldwide blessing are promised.
Abram believes God	Genesis 15:6 — faith is counted for righteousness.

Story movement	Scripture
The covenant is confirmed	Genesis 15; 17; 22.

1. Babel: Man's Name and God's Judgment

God tells Noah's descendants to fill the earth. At Babel they remain together, build upward, and seek a name for themselves. God confounds their language and scatters them across the earth.

> **Genesis 11:4 —** *Go to, let us build us a city and a tower...and let us make us a name, lest we be scattered abroad upon the face of the whole earth.*

NOTE — The builders of Babel wanted to make themselves a _____.

NOTE — God scattered the people by confounding their _____.

2. Abraham: God's Name and God's Promise

God answers the pride of the nations by calling one man. Abram leaves his country at God's word. The promises of land, seed, and blessing become a major line through the rest of Scripture.

Abraham is not presented as perfect. His failures are recorded, but God's covenant faithfulness and Abraham's believing response remain central.

> **Genesis 15:6 —** *And he believed in the LORD; and he counted it to him for righteousness.*

The Abrahamic Promises

Promise	Content	Main passages
Land	A literal land is promised to Abraham's seed	Genesis 12:1, 7; 13:14–17; 15:18–21

Promise	Content	Main passages
Seed	Abraham will become a great nation and father of many nations	Genesis 12:2; 15:1–6; 17:1–8
Blessing	God will bless Abraham and bless all families through his seed	Genesis 12:2–3; 22:15–18; Galatians 3:16

NOTE — The covenant promises include land, seed, and _____.

NOTE — Abraham believed God, and it was counted for _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. What did mankind seek at Babel?
2. How did God judge Babel?
3. What did God command Abram to leave?
4. State the land, seed, and blessing promises.
5. How does the New Testament connect Abraham's promised Seed with Christ?

UNIT 2 — THE FAMILY THAT BECOMES ISRAEL

Lesson 5 — Isaac and Jacob: The Promise Continues and Israel Is Named

Lesson Overview: The covenant line continues through Isaac, the promised son of Abraham and Sarah, and then through Jacob. God changes Jacob's name to Israel, and Jacob's twelve sons become the tribal fathers of the nation.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 17:15–21; Genesis 21–22; Genesis 25–35; Genesis 48–49; Numbers 1:5–16

KEY VERSE | Genesis 32:28 — *Thy name shall be called no more Jacob, but Israel: for as a prince hast thou power with God and with men, and hast prevailed.*

READ: Genesis 17:15–21; 21:1–12; 22:1–18; 25:19–34; 27–28; 32:22–32; 35:9–29; 48–49; 1 Chronicles 2:1–2.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Isaac is born	Genesis 21:1–7 — God fulfills His promise to Abraham and Sarah.
Isaac is offered	Genesis 22:1–18 — God provides a ram and confirms the promise.
Jacob receives the birthright and blessing	Genesis 25:29–34; 27:1–40.
God meets Jacob at Bethel	Genesis 28:10–22 — the Abrahamic promises are repeated.

Story movement	Scripture
Jacob becomes Israel	Genesis 32:22–32; 35:9–12.
Israel's twelve sons are named	Genesis 35:22–26; 49:1–28.

1. Isaac: The Promised Son

Isaac is born when Abraham and Sarah are old, proving that the promise depends upon God's power. At Moriah, Abraham obeys God, Isaac is bound, and God provides a ram in his place.

> **Genesis 22:8 —** *My son, God will provide himself a lamb for a burnt offering...*

NOTE — Isaac was the promised son of Abraham and _____.

NOTE — At Moriah God provided a _____ in Isaac's place.

2. Jacob Becomes Israel

Jacob often relies on planning and deception, but God disciplines and preserves him. At Bethel God repeats the covenant. At Peniel Jacob is broken, blessed, and renamed Israel.

From Abraham to Israel's Tribes

Generation	Key people	Place in the story	Passages
1	Abraham and Sarah	Receive the covenant promises	Genesis 12; 15; 17
2	Isaac and Rebekah	The promise continues through Isaac	Genesis 21–27
3	Jacob / Israel	Receives the promise and becomes father of twelve sons	Genesis 28; 32; 35

Generation	Key people	Place in the story	Passages
4	Twelve sons	Become the tribal fathers of Israel	Genesis 35:22–26; 49

NOTE — God changed Jacob's name to _____.

NOTE — Jacob's twelve sons became the tribal fathers of _____.

3. The Twelve Sons

Levi is set apart for priestly service. Joseph receives a double tribal portion through Ephraim and Manasseh. Judah receives the royal promise that leads to David and Jesus Christ.

Jacob's Sons and Important Tribal Connections

Mother	Sons	Important connection
Leah	Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zebulun	Priesthood through Levi; royal line through Judah
Rachel	Joseph, Benjamin	Joseph represented by Ephraim and Manasseh
Bilhah	Dan, Naphtali	Tribal fathers in Israel
Zilpah	Gad, Asher	Tribal fathers in Israel

NOTE — Joseph's sons Ephraim and _____ received tribal standing.

NOTE — The royal line comes through the tribe of _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. Why was Isaac's birth important to the covenant story?
2. What did God provide at Moriah?
3. Where did God repeat the Abrahamic promises to Jacob?
4. Why did God rename Jacob Israel?
5. How do Levi, Joseph, and Judah have special tribal roles?

UNIT 2 — THE FAMILY THAT BECOMES ISRAEL

Lesson 6 — Joseph: God Sends a Preserver to Egypt

Lesson Overview: Joseph is hated, sold, falsely accused, and imprisoned, but the LORD remains with him. God raises him beside Pharaoh and uses him to preserve Jacob's family, moving Israel into Egypt for the next stage of the story.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 37–50; Psalm 105:16–24; Acts 7:9–16; Hebrews 11:22

KEY VERSE | Genesis 50:20 — *But as for you, ye thought evil against me; but God meant it unto good…to save much people alive.*

READ: Genesis 37; 39–50; Psalm 105:16–24; Acts 7:9–16; Hebrews 11:22.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Joseph dreams	Genesis 37:1–11 — his brothers and parents will bow before him.
Joseph is sold	Genesis 37:18–36 — he is taken into Egypt.
Joseph serves and suffers	Genesis 39–40 — the LORD is with him in Potiphar's house and prison.
Joseph interprets Pharaoh's dreams	Genesis 41 — he is raised to authority.
Joseph's brothers come for food	Genesis 42–45 — Joseph tests and reveals himself to them.
Jacob's family moves to Egypt	Genesis 46–47.

Story movement	Scripture
Joseph explains God's providence	Genesis 50:15–21.

1. From Favorite Son to Prisoner

Jacob favors Joseph, and Joseph's dreams intensify his brothers' hatred. They sell him into Egypt. In Potiphar's house and in prison, Joseph refuses sin and remains faithful even when obedience brings suffering.

> **Genesis 39:9 —** *How then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?*

NOTE — Joseph's brothers sold him into _____.

NOTE — Joseph refused temptation because it was sin against _____.

2. From Prisoner to Preserver

God gives Joseph understanding of dreams. Pharaoh appoints him over Egypt, and Joseph stores food before the famine. The famine brings his brothers before him and eventually brings Jacob's whole household into Egypt.

Joseph's Reversals

Low point	God's providence	Result	Passages
Rejected by brothers	Taken to Egypt	Placed in Potiphar's house	Genesis 37; 39:1–6
Falsely accused	The LORD is with him in prison	Trusted by the keeper	Genesis 39:7–23
Forgotten by the butler	Pharaoh dreams at God's appointed time	Joseph is summoned	Genesis 40–41

Low point	God's providence	Result	Passages
Family famine	Joseph has stored food	Israel's household is preserved	Genesis 42–47

NOTE — Pharaoh appointed Joseph over the land of _____.

NOTE — God used Joseph to preserve Jacob's _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. Why did Joseph's brothers hate him?
2. How did Joseph respond to temptation?
3. How was the LORD with Joseph during suffering?
4. Why did Jacob's family move to Egypt?
5. How does Genesis 50:20 summarize God's providence?

UNIT 3 — ISRAEL IS CALLED OUT AND ESTABLISHED

Lesson 7 — Moses and Pharaoh: Passover and the Exodus

Lesson Overview: Egypt enslaves Israel, but God remembers His covenant, calls Moses, judges Egypt, shelters Israel through the Passover blood, and brings the nation through the Red Sea.

MAIN PASSAGES: Exodus 1–15; Psalm 105:23–45; 1 Corinthians 5:7; Hebrews 11:23–29

KEY VERSE | Exodus 12:13 — *And the blood shall be to you for a token upon the houses where ye are: and when I see the blood, I will pass over you…*

READ: Exodus 1–6; 7–11; 12:1–51; 13:17–15:21; Psalm 105:23–45; 1 Corinthians 5:7; Hebrews 11:23–29.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Israel is enslaved	Exodus 1:8–22.
Moses is preserved	Exodus 2:1–10; Hebrews 11:23.
God calls Moses	Exodus 3:1–4:17.
The plagues strike Egypt	Exodus 7–11; 12:12.
The Passover lamb is slain	Exodus 12:1–36.
Israel leaves Egypt	Exodus 12:37–51.

Story movement	Scripture
God opens the Red Sea	Exodus 14–15.

1. Moses Is Called

Pharaoh oppresses Israel and orders Hebrew sons killed. God preserves Moses, trains him in Pharaoh's house and Midian, then calls him from the burning bush. Moses is sent because God has seen Israel's affliction and remembered His covenant.

> **Exodus 3:14 —** *And God said unto Moses, I AM THAT I AM…*

NOTE — God called Moses from the burning _____.

NOTE — God revealed His name as I AM THAT _____.

2. Pharaoh, the Plagues, and Passover

Pharaoh repeatedly hardens his heart. The plagues reveal the LORD's power and judge Egypt's gods. Before the final plague, each Israelite household must kill a lamb without blemish and place its blood on the doorposts and lintel.

Passover Instructions

Element	Instruction	Meaning in the story	Scripture
Lamb	Male of the first year, without blemish	A spotless substitute is selected	Exodus 12:3–5
Blood	Placed on two side posts and upper door post	Marks the house under God's promise	Exodus 12:7, 13
Meal	Roasted lamb, unleavened bread, bitter herbs	Israel eats ready to depart	Exodus 12:8–11

Element	Instruction	Meaning in the story	Scripture
Memorial	Kept as a feast in Israel	The deliverance is remembered	Exodus 12:14–28
Christ	Called our Passover	The New Testament identifies the greater sacrifice	1 Corinthians 5:7; 1 Peter 1:18–19

NOTE — The Passover lamb had to be without _____.

NOTE — God said, ***"when I see the _____, I will pass over you."***

3. Through the Sea

Pharaoh pursues the departing nation. God opens the Red Sea, Israel crosses on dry ground, and the waters destroy Egypt's army. Moses and the people sing that the LORD has triumphed gloriously.

NOTE — Israel crossed the Red Sea on dry _____.

NOTE — The Exodus calls Israel out from bondage in _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. Why did God send Moses to Pharaoh?
2. What did the plagues reveal about the LORD?
3. What were the instructions for the Passover lamb and blood?
4. How does the New Testament connect Passover with Christ?
5. What did crossing the Red Sea accomplish for Israel?

UNIT 3 — ISRAEL IS CALLED OUT AND ESTABLISHED

Lesson 8 — Moses in the Wilderness: Sinai, the Tabernacle, and Kadesh

Lesson Overview: God brings the redeemed nation to Sinai, gives the Law, establishes the priesthood and sacrifices, and places the tabernacle at the center. Israel's unbelief at Kadesh brings forty years of wandering before Joshua leads the next generation.

MAIN PASSAGES: Exodus 19–40; Leviticus 1–17; Numbers 13–21; Deuteronomy 6–8; Hebrews 9–10

KEY VERSE | Exodus 25:8 — *And let them make me a sanctuary; that I may dwell among them.*

READ: Exodus 19–24; 25–31; 32–34; 40; Leviticus 1–7; 16–17; Numbers 13–14; 21:4–9; Deuteronomy 6–8; 31; 34; Hebrews 9–10.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Israel arrives at Sinai	Exodus 19 — God calls the nation a peculiar treasure, kingdom of priests, and holy nation.
God gives the commandments	Exodus 20–24.
God gives the tabernacle pattern	Exodus 25–31.
Israel worships the golden calf	Exodus 32–34.

Story movement	Scripture
The glory fills the tabernacle	Exodus 40:33–38.
Israel refuses the land	Numbers 13–14.
God provides the brazen serpent	Numbers 21:4–9; John 3:14–15.

1. Sinai: A Redeemed Nation Receives the Law

God redeems Israel before giving the Law. The Mosaic covenant orders Israel's national life, worship, sacrifices, calendar, and justice. The Law also exposes sin and teaches that the LORD is holy.

> **Exodus 19:6 —** *And ye shall be unto me a kingdom of priests, and an holy nation.*

NOTE — God redeemed Israel before giving the _____.

NOTE — Israel was called a kingdom of priests and an holy _____.

2. The Tabernacle: God Dwells Among Israel

The tabernacle stands at the center of Israel's camp. Its court, altar, laver, holy place, and most holy place show that Israel must approach a holy God in the way He commands.

The Tabernacle and Its Furniture

Area	Furniture	Function	Study
Court	Brazen altar	Sacrifice is offered	Exodus 27:1–8; Leviticus 1
Court	Laver	Priests wash before service	Exodus 30:17–21

Area	Furniture	Function	Study
Holy place	Candlestick	Light burns before the LORD	Exodus 25:31–40
Holy place	Table of shewbread	Bread stands before the LORD	Exodus 25:23–30
Holy place	Altar of incense	Incense rises before the veil	Exodus 30:1–10
Most holy place	Ark and mercy seat	God meets with the high priest	Exodus 25:10–22; Leviticus 16

NOTE — The tabernacle stood at the center of Israel's _____.

NOTE — The ark and mercy seat stood in the most _____ place.

3. Kadesh: Unbelief Delays the Journey

Ten spies magnify the giants; Joshua and Caleb trust the LORD. The nation refuses the land and wanders forty years. God continues to provide and prepares Joshua to lead the next generation.

The Kadesh Decision

Response	Spokesmen	Message	Result
Unbelief	Ten spies	The people are stronger; we cannot go up	Israel fears and rebels
Faith	Joshua and Caleb	The LORD is with us; fear them not	They are preserved to enter the land
Judgment	The LORD	The unbelieving generation will not enter	Forty years of wandering

NOTE — Israel wandered forty years because of _____.

NOTE — Joshua and _____ trusted God to give the land.

Check Your Understanding

1. Why is the order of redemption and Law important?
2. What did the Law regulate in Israel's national life?
3. How did the tabernacle teach God's holiness and presence?
4. Why did Israel refuse the land at Kadesh?
5. How did God prepare the next generation to enter?

UNIT 3 — ISRAEL IS CALLED OUT AND ESTABLISHED

Lesson 9 — Joshua and Rahab: Israel Enters the Promised Land

Lesson Overview: Joshua succeeds Moses and leads Israel across Jordan. Rahab believes the LORD and is preserved at Jericho. God gives the main victories, the land is divided among the tribes, and Israel renews the covenant.

MAIN PASSAGES: Joshua 1–24; Hebrews 11:30–31; James 2:25; Psalm 78:52–55

KEY VERSE | Joshua 1:9 — *Have not I commanded thee? Be strong and of a good courage…for the LORD thy God is with thee whithersoever thou goest.*

READ: Joshua 1–8; 10–12; 13–21; 23–24; Hebrews 11:30–31; James 2:25.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Joshua is commissioned	Joshua 1:1–9.
Rahab receives the spies	Joshua 2; Hebrews 11:31.
Israel crosses Jordan	Joshua 3–4.
Jericho falls	Joshua 5:13–6:27; Hebrews 11:30.
Achan's sin is judged	Joshua 7.
The land is conquered and divided	Joshua 10–21.

Story movement	Scripture
Joshua renews the covenant	Joshua 23–24.

1. Joshua Leads by God's Word

Joshua's courage is tied to obedience. He is to meditate in the book of the Law and do what it says. God brings Israel across Jordan and commands memorial stones so later generations will know what He did.

NOTE — Joshua was commanded to meditate in the book of the _____.

NOTE — Israel set up twelve memorial _____ after crossing Jordan.

2. Rahab Believes the LORD

Rahab has heard what the LORD did in Egypt and believes that He is God in Heaven and earth. She hides the spies and places the scarlet line in her window. Her household is preserved when Jericho falls, and she later appears in the line of David and Christ.

Joshua 2:11 — *...the LORD your God, he is God in heaven above, and in earth beneath.*

NOTE — Rahab placed a scarlet _____ in her window.

NOTE — Rahab believed that the LORD is God in Heaven and _____.

3. Conquest, Inheritance, and Choice

Jericho falls by God's power. Achan's hidden sin brings defeat at Ai until it is judged. The major campaigns break Canaanite resistance, the tribes receive inheritances, and Joshua calls Israel to choose whom they will serve.

Joshua's Major Movements

Movement	Story	Scripture
Entrance	Jordan crossing and memorial stones	Joshua 3–4
Central campaign	Jericho, Achan, and Ai	Joshua 5–8
Southern campaign	Gibeon and southern kings	Joshua 9–10
Northern campaign	Northern coalition defeated	Joshua 11–12
Inheritance	Land divided among the tribes	Joshua 13–21
Renewal	Joshua's final charge and covenant renewal	Joshua 23–24

NOTE — Achan's hidden _____ brought defeat at Ai.

NOTE — Joshua said, ***"choose you this day whom ye will _____."***

Check Your Understanding

1. How were Joshua's courage and obedience connected?
2. What did Rahab believe about the LORD?
3. Why did Jericho fall?
4. What did Achan's story teach Israel?
5. How did Joshua complete Israel's entrance into the land?

UNIT 3 — ISRAEL IS CALLED OUT AND ESTABLISHED

Lesson 10 — The Judges and Ruth: Collapse, Deliverance, and a Redeemer

Lesson Overview: After Joshua, Israel repeatedly forsakes the LORD, suffers oppression, cries for help, and receives deliverance through judges. During this unstable period, Ruth trusts Israel's God, Boaz redeems her family, and the line of David is preserved.

MAIN PASSAGES: Judges 1–21; Ruth 1–4; Hebrews 11:32–34; Matthew 1:5–6

KEY VERSE | Ruth 1:16 — *...thy people shall be my people, and thy God my God:*

READ: Judges 2:6–23; 3–8; 10–16; 17:6; 21:25; Ruth 1–4; Hebrews 11:32–34; Matthew 1:5–6.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Israel forsakes the LORD	Judges 2:6–15.
God raises judges	Judges 2:16–19.
Deborah and Barak deliver Israel	Judges 4–5.
Gideon defeats Midian	Judges 6–8.
Samson fights the Philistines	Judges 13–16.

Story movement	Scripture
Ruth follows Naomi to Bethlehem	Ruth 1.
Boaz redeems Ruth	Ruth 2–4.

1. The Cycle of the Judges

Israel fails to remove idolatry from the land. Each generation turns from the LORD, and the same pattern repeats. The problem is summarized in the words, ***"every man did that which was right in his own eyes."***

The Judges Cycle

Step	What happens	Key passages
Sin	Israel serves other gods	Judges 2:11–13
Oppression	God gives Israel into enemy hands	Judges 2:14–15
Crying	The people groan under bondage	Judges 2:18; 3:9, 15
Deliverer	The LORD raises a judge	Judges 2:16, 18
Rest	The land rests while the judge lives	Judges 3:11, 30; 5:31
Return	The people become corrupt again	Judges 2:19

NOTE — God raised judges to _____ Israel.

NOTE — Every man did what was right in his own _____.

2. Ruth and Boaz

Ruth is a Moabitess who chooses Naomi's people and God. She works in the field of Boaz, a near kinsman. Boaz willingly redeems the family inheritance and marries Ruth.

Their son Obed becomes the father of Jesse and grandfather of David. In the darkest period of Judges, God quietly preserves the royal line.

Ruth's Place in the Story

Character	Action	Importance	Passages
Naomi	Returns to Bethlehem in bitterness	The family and inheritance need restoration	Ruth 1
Ruth	Trusts Israel's God and serves faithfully	A Gentile believer enters Israel and David's line	Ruth 1–2; Matthew 1:5
Boaz	Acts as kinsman-redeemer	Redeems the inheritance and takes Ruth as wife	Ruth 2–4
Obed	Son of Boaz and Ruth	Grandfather of David	Ruth 4:13–22

NOTE — Boaz served as Ruth's kinsman-_____.

NOTE — Ruth became the great-grandmother of King _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. What caused the repeated cycle in Judges?
2. Name several judges and the enemies they faced.
3. What did Ruth choose in Ruth 1:16?
4. What did Boaz do as kinsman-redeemer?
5. How does Ruth connect Judges with David and Christ?

UNIT 4 — ISRAEL'S KINGS AND PROPHETS

Lesson 11 — Samuel and Saul: From Judges to Kings

Lesson Overview: Samuel hears God's voice and leads Israel at the end of the judges. The nation demands a king like the surrounding nations. Saul begins with promise but repeatedly disobeys, and God rejects his dynasty.

MAIN PASSAGES: 1 Samuel 1–15; 1 Samuel 28–31; Acts 13:20–22

KEY VERSE | 1 Samuel 15:22 — *Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to hearken than the fat of rams.*

READ: 1 Samuel 1–3; 7–10; 12–15; 28–31; Acts 13:20–22.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Hannah prays for a son	1 Samuel 1.
Samuel hears the LORD	1 Samuel 3.
Samuel judges Israel	1 Samuel 7.
Israel demands a king	1 Samuel 8.
Saul is chosen and anointed	1 Samuel 9–10.
Saul acts presumptuously	1 Samuel 13.

Story movement	Scripture
Saul spares Agag	1 Samuel 15.
Saul dies on Gilboa	1 Samuel 28–31.

1. Samuel: A Prophet Who Hears God

Hannah dedicates Samuel to the LORD. As a boy, he hears God's call while the word of the LORD is precious in Israel. Samuel grows as prophet and judge and leads the nation back from idolatry.

1 Samuel 3:10 — *Speak; for thy servant heareth.*

NOTE — Samuel answered, ***"Speak; for thy servant _____."***

NOTE — Samuel served as prophet and _____ in Israel.

2. Saul: A King Who Will Not Obey

Israel's request for a king reveals rejection of the LORD's rule. Saul has outward advantages, but he will not submit fully to God's Word. His presumption in 1 Samuel 13 and partial obedience in chapter 15 cost his house the kingdom.

Saul's Rise and Rejection

Stage	Event	What it reveals	Scripture
Chosen	Saul is publicly presented	Outward strength and public approval	1 Samuel 9–10
Presumptuous	Offers sacrifice instead of waiting	Will not remain under God's command	1 Samuel 13:8–14
Partly obedient	Spares Agag and the best spoil	Calls disobedience obedience	1 Samuel 15:1–23

Stage	Event	What it reveals	Scripture
Rejected	Kingdom will not continue in his line	God seeks a man after His own heart	1 Samuel 13:14; 15:26–29
Ruined	Consults the witch at Endor and dies	A tragic end to continued rebellion	1 Samuel 28–31

NOTE — Israel demanded a king like the other _____.

NOTE — Saul learned that to obey is better than _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. How did Samuel enter the LORD's service?
2. Why was Israel's demand for a king spiritually serious?
3. What happened at Gilgal in 1 Samuel 13?
4. What did Saul do with Agag and the spoil?
5. Why did God reject Saul's dynasty?

UNIT 4 — ISRAEL'S KINGS AND PROPHETS

Lesson 12 — David: Shepherd, Warrior, King, and Covenant Man

Lesson Overview: God chooses David from Judah, tests him through Goliath and Saul, and establishes him as king in Jerusalem. David sins seriously and faces consequences, yet he repents. God promises him an enduring house, throne, and kingdom fulfilled in Jesus Christ.

MAIN PASSAGES: 1 Samuel 16–31; 2 Samuel 1–24; 1 Chronicles 10–29; Psalm 51; Psalm 89; Luke 1:30–33

KEY VERSE | 2 Samuel 7:16 — *And thine house and thy kingdom shall be established for ever before thee: thy throne shall be established for ever.*

READ: 1 Samuel 16–17; 18–24; 30–31; 2 Samuel 2; 5–7; 11–12; 15–19; 22–24; Psalm 51; 89:19–37; Luke 1:30–33.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
David is anointed	1 Samuel 16.
David defeats Goliath	1 Samuel 17.
David flees Saul	1 Samuel 18–24.
David becomes king	2 Samuel 2; 5.
God makes the Davidic covenant	2 Samuel 7.

Story movement	Scripture
David sins and repents	2 Samuel 11–12; Psalm 51.
Absalom rebels	2 Samuel 15–19.
David prepares for the temple	1 Chronicles 22–29.

1. David Is Chosen and Tested

God looks on David's heart rather than outward appearance. David faces Goliath in the name of the LORD and later refuses to seize Saul's throne. Years of danger prepare the shepherd to rule the nation.

David's Preparation

Test	David's response	Lesson	Scripture
Anointing	Receives God's choice while still a shepherd	God sees the heart	1 Samuel 16:1–13
Goliath	Trusts the name of the LORD	Victory belongs to God	1 Samuel 17
Saul's hatred	Flees without taking revenge	Waits for God's time	1 Samuel 18–24
Ziklag	Encourages himself in the LORD	Seeks God in loss	1 Samuel 30

NOTE — God looks on the _____ rather than outward appearance.

NOTE — David faced Goliath in the name of the _____.

2. David Rules and Receives the Covenant

David unites Israel, captures Jerusalem, and brings the ark to the city. God refuses David's plan to build the temple but promises to build David a house—an enduring dynasty, throne, and kingdom.

> **Luke 1:32–33 —** *...the Lord God shall give unto him the throne of his father David: And he shall reign over the house of Jacob for ever...*

NOTE — David made _____ the royal capital.

NOTE — God promised David an enduring house, throne, and _____.

3. David Sins and Repents

David commits adultery with Bathsheba and arranges Uriah's death. Nathan confronts him with the words, ***"Thou art the man."*** David confesses, receives forgiveness, and bears painful consequences in his household.

> **Psalm 51:10 —** *Create in me a clean heart, O God; and renew a right spirit within me.*

NOTE — Nathan confronted David by saying, ***"Thou art the _____."***

NOTE — David asked God to create in him a clean _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. Why did God choose David?
2. What did David's years under Saul teach him?
3. What did God promise in the Davidic covenant?
4. How did Nathan confront David's sin?
5. How does Jesus fulfill the promise to David?

UNIT 4 — ISRAEL'S KINGS AND PROPHETS

Lesson 13 — Solomon, Rehoboam, and Jeroboam: Temple Glory and a Divided Kingdom

Lesson Overview: Solomon receives wisdom, builds the temple, and rules at the height of the united kingdom. His compromised heart prepares judgment. Rehoboam's harsh answer and Jeroboam's false worship divide the nation into Israel and Judah.

MAIN PASSAGES: 1 Kings 1–12; 2 Chronicles 1–12; Deuteronomy 17:14–20; Ecclesiastes 12:13–14

KEY VERSE | 1 Kings 12:20 — *...there was none that followed the house of David, but the tribe of Judah only.*

READ: 1 Kings 1–3; 5–8; 10–12; 2 Chronicles 1–12; Deuteronomy 17:14–20; Ecclesiastes 12:13–14.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Solomon asks for wisdom	1 Kings 3.
Solomon builds the temple	1 Kings 5–8.
The kingdom reaches glory	1 Kings 10.
Solomon's heart turns	1 Kings 11:1–13.

Story movement	Scripture
Rehoboam rejects wise counsel	1 Kings 12:1–15.
The kingdom divides	1 Kings 12:16–24.
Jeroboam creates false worship	1 Kings 12:25–33.

1. Solomon: Wisdom, Temple, and Compromise

Solomon asks for an understanding heart. He builds and dedicates the temple, and Israel reaches great wealth and influence. Yet he multiplies horses, riches, and wives contrary to Deuteronomy 17, and his wives turn his heart after other gods.

Solomon's Reign

Stage	Strength or failure	Scripture
Wisdom	God gives wisdom to judge Israel	1 Kings 3:5–28; 4:29–34
Temple	The house of the LORD is built and dedicated	1 Kings 5–8
Glory	Israel reaches great wealth and international influence	1 Kings 10
Compromise	Horses, riches, and wives multiply	Deuteronomy 17:14–20; 1 Kings 10–11
Judgment	God announces that the kingdom will be torn	1 Kings 11:9–13, 26–40

NOTE — Solomon built the temple in _____.

NOTE — Solomon's wives turned his _____ after other gods.

2. Rehoboam and Jeroboam Divide the Nation

Rehoboam answers the people's request harshly, and ten tribes follow Jeroboam. Jeroboam fears that worship in Jerusalem will reunite the people, so he establishes golden calves, false priests, and a substitute feast.

The Split Kingdom

Feature	Northern Kingdom — Israel	Southern Kingdom — Judah
First ruler	Jeroboam I	Rehoboam
Tribes	Ten northern tribes	Judah and Benjamin; faithful Levites also move south
Capital	First Shechem; later Samaria	Jerusalem
Worship	Golden calves at Bethel and Dan	Temple at Jerusalem
Ruling line	Several changing dynasties	Davidic dynasty
Final exile	Assyria takes Samaria	Babylon destroys Jerusalem
Main passages	1 Kings 12–2 Kings 17	1 Kings 12–2 Kings 25; 2 Chronicles 10–36

NOTE — Jeroboam ruled the northern kingdom called _____.

NOTE — Rehoboam ruled the southern kingdom called _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. What did Solomon ask God to give him?
2. What did the temple represent in Israel's story?
3. Which warnings in Deuteronomy 17 did Solomon violate?
4. Why did the kingdom divide after Solomon?
5. How did Jeroboam establish counterfeit worship?

UNIT 4 — ISRAEL'S KINGS AND PROPHETS

Lesson 14 — Elijah, Elisha, the Kings, and the Prophets: Warning Before Exile

Lesson Overview: Israel and Judah continue under different kings while prophets call both kingdoms back to the LORD. Elijah and Elisha confront northern apostasy. Isaiah, Jeremiah, and other prophets warn Judah. Israel falls to Assyria, and Judah later falls to Babylon.

MAIN PASSAGES: 1 Kings 16–22; 2 Kings 1–25; 2 Chronicles 13–36; Isaiah; Jeremiah; Hosea; Amos

KEY VERSE | 2 Kings 17:13 — *Yet the LORD testified against Israel, and against Judah, by all the prophets, and by all the seers, saying, Turn ye from your evil ways…*

READ: 1 Kings 16:29–22:53; 2 Kings 1–10; 13–25; 2 Chronicles 26–36; Isaiah 1; 6; 36–39; Jeremiah 1; 7; 25; Hosea 4; Amos 5.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Ahab and Jezebel establish Baal worship	1 Kings 16:29–34.
Elijah confronts Israel at Carmel	1 Kings 17–18.
Elisha continues the witness	2 Kings 2–8.

Story movement	Scripture
Israel rejects the prophets	2 Kings 17:7–23.
Assyria takes Samaria	2 Kings 17:5–6.
Hezekiah trusts the LORD	2 Kings 18–20; Isaiah 36–39.
Josiah responds to the Law	2 Kings 22–23.
Babylon destroys Jerusalem	2 Kings 24–25; 2 Chronicles 36.

1. Elijah and Elisha Confront the Northern Kingdom

Ahab and Jezebel make Baal worship official. Elijah announces drought, is sustained by God, and challenges the prophets of Baal at Carmel. Elisha succeeds him and continues the prophetic witness through signs, warnings, and counsel.

> **1 Kings 18:21 —** *How long halt ye between two opinions? if the LORD be God, follow him…*

NOTE — Elijah confronted the prophets of _____ at Carmel.

NOTE — Elisha succeeded the prophet _____.

2. The Kings and Prophets of Israel

Every northern dynasty continues Jeroboam's false worship. Jonah, Amos, and Hosea minister during the later northern kingdom. The nation refuses repeated warnings, and Assyria captures Samaria.

Northern Kingdom — Selected Kings and Prophets

Period	Selected kings	Prophets and message	Outcome / study
First dynasty	Jeroboam I, Nadab	A man of God condemns the altar	Counterfeit worship begins (1 Kings 12–14)
Baasha to Omri	Baasha, Elah, Zimri, Omri	Jehu son of Hanani warns Baasha	Dynasties change through violence (1 Kings 15–16)
House of Omri	Ahab, Ahaziah, Joram	Elijah and Elisha confront Baal	Drought, Carmel, signs, judgment (1 Kings 17–2 Kings 9)
House of Jehu	Jehu, Jehoahaz, Joash, Jeroboam II	Jonah, Amos, Hosea	Temporary strength; deep corruption (2 Kings 10–14)
Final years	Zechariah, Shallum, Menahem, Pekahiah, Pekah, Hoshea	Warnings continue, but Israel will not hear	Samaria falls to Assyria (2 Kings 15–17)

NOTE — Assyria captured the northern capital of _____.

NOTE — Hosea and Amos warned the northern kingdom of _____.

3. Judah's Reforms and Final Fall

Judah keeps David's line but repeatedly follows idolatry. Hezekiah trusts God during the Assyrian crisis, and Josiah responds to the recovered Law. Isaiah, Micah, Jeremiah, Habakkuk, and Zephaniah warn Judah. At last Babylon destroys Jerusalem and the temple.

Southern Kingdom — Selected Kings and Prophets

Period	Selected rulers	Prophets and message	Outcome / study
Early kingdom	Rehoboam, Abijah, Asa, Jehoshaphat	Shemaiah, Azariah, Hanani, Jehu	Compromise and reform (2 Chronicles 10–20)
Athaliah crisis	Jehoram, Ahaziah, Athaliah, Joash	Elijah's letter; Jehoiada and Zechariah	David's line preserved (2 Chronicles 21–24)
Assyrian era	Amaziah, Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, Hezekiah	Isaiah, Micah, Hosea	Jerusalem delivered from Assyria (2 Kings 18–20)
Final reform	Manasseh, Amon, Josiah	Nahum, Zephaniah, Jeremiah	Josiah responds to the Law (2 Kings 21–23)
Final kings	Jehoahaz, Jehoiakim, Jehoiachin, Zedekiah	Jeremiah, Habakkuk, Ezekiel	Jerusalem falls to Babylon (2 Kings 24–25)

NOTE — Hezekiah trusted God during the _____ crisis.

NOTE — Babylon destroyed Jerusalem and the _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. What did Elijah prove at Mount Carmel?
2. How did Elisha continue Elijah's ministry?
3. Why did Assyria conquer the northern kingdom?
4. What did Hezekiah and Josiah do differently from many kings?
5. Why did Babylon finally destroy Jerusalem?

UNIT 5 — EXILE, PRESERVATION, AND RETURN

Lesson 15 — Daniel, Esther, Ezra, and Nehemiah: God Preserves His People

Lesson Overview: During Gentile rule, Daniel shows that the most High governs kingdoms, Esther's story displays providential preservation, and the return leaders rebuild the temple, teach the Law, and restore Jerusalem's walls while Israel awaits the promised King.

MAIN PASSAGES: Daniel 1–9; Esther 1–10; Ezra 1–10; Nehemiah 1–13; Haggai; Zechariah; Malachi

KEY VERSE | Daniel 2:21 — *And he changeth the times and the seasons: he removeth kings, and setteth up kings...*

READ: Daniel 1–7; 9; Esther 3–9; Ezra 1–7; Nehemiah 1–8; Haggai 1–2; Zechariah 9; 12–14; Malachi 3–4.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Daniel purposes faithfulness	Daniel 1.
God reveals the course of kingdoms	Daniel 2; 7.
The three Hebrews refuse the image	Daniel 3.

Story movement	Scripture
Daniel survives the lions' den	Daniel 6.
Esther intercedes for her people	Esther 3–9.
Zerubbabel rebuilds the temple	Ezra 1–6; Haggai; Zechariah.
Ezra teaches the Law	Ezra 7–10.
Nehemiah rebuilds the wall	Nehemiah 1–8.

1. Daniel and His Friends in Gentile Kingdoms

Daniel and his friends remain faithful in Babylon. The image in Daniel 2 and beasts in Daniel 7 trace Gentile empires toward the kingdom given to the Son of man. God preserves His servants in the furnace and lions' den.

Daniel's Kingdom Visions

Empire	Daniel 2 image	Daniel 7 beast	Historical kingdom
1	Head of gold	Lion	Babylon
2	Breast and arms of silver	Bear	Medo-Persia
3	Belly and thighs of brass	Leopard	Greece
4	Legs of iron; feet of iron and clay	Dreadful beast with ten horns	Rome and its final form

Empire	Daniel 2 image	Daniel 7 beast	Historical kingdom
Final	Stone becomes a great mountain	Son of man receives the kingdom	Christ's everlasting kingdom

NOTE — Daniel purposed in his _____ not to defile himself.

NOTE — The most High rules in the kingdom of _____.

2. Esther and God's Providential Preservation

Haman plots to destroy the Jews throughout Persia. Mordecai challenges Esther to act, and she approaches the king at the risk of her life. The plot is reversed, Haman is judged, and the Jewish people are preserved.

> **Esther 4:14 —** *...who knoweth whether thou art come to the kingdom for such a time as this?*

NOTE — Mordecai told Esther she may have come for such a _____ as this.

NOTE — God preserved the Jewish people from Haman's _____.

3. The Return Leaders

Cyrus permits the return. Zerubbabel and Jeshua rebuild the temple. Ezra teaches the Law. Nehemiah rebuilds Jerusalem's wall and leads covenant renewal. The restored nation remains under Gentile rule and still awaits Messiah.

The Main Returns to Jerusalem

Leader	Persian ruler	Main work	Bible record
Zerubbabel and Jeshua	Cyrus	Return, altar, and rebuilt temple	Ezra 1–6; Haggai; Zechariah

Leader	Persian ruler	Main work	Bible record
Ezra	Artaxerxes	Teach the Law and correct disorder	Ezra 7–10
Nehemiah	Artaxerxes	Rebuild the wall and renew covenant order	Nehemiah 1–13

NOTE — Zerubbabel led the rebuilding of the _____.

NOTE — Nehemiah led the rebuilding of Jerusalem's _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. What did Daniel decide before facing Babylon's tests?
2. How do Daniel 2 and 7 describe Gentile kingdoms?
3. How did Esther help preserve the Jewish people?
4. What work belongs to Zerubbabel, Ezra, and Nehemiah?
5. What promises still remained unfulfilled after the return?

UNIT 6 — JESUS CHRIST, THE PROMISED KING

Lesson 16 — John the Baptist, Mary, Joseph, and Jesus: The King Comes to Israel

Lesson Overview: After centuries of prophetic expectation, John prepares the way, Jesus is born of a virgin in Bethlehem, and the eternal Word becomes flesh. His teaching, signs, and call of the disciples reveal Him as Israel's Messiah, Son of God, and promised King.

MAIN PASSAGES: Matthew 1–17; Mark 1–9; Luke 1–9; John 1–12; Isaiah 7:14; Micah 5:2

KEY VERSE | Luke 2:11 — *For unto you is born this day in the city of David a Saviour, which is Christ the Lord.*

READ: Matthew 1–4; 8–9; 13; 16–17; Mark 1–9; Luke 1–2; 4–9; John 1–12; Isaiah 7:14; 9:6–7; Micah 5:2.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
John's birth is announced	Luke 1:5–25, 57–80.
Jesus' birth is announced	Luke 1:26–38; Matthew 1:18–25.
Jesus is born in Bethlehem	Luke 2:1–20; Matthew 2:1–12.
John prepares Israel	Matthew 3:1–12; John 1:19–36.

Story movement	Scripture
Jesus is baptized and tempted	Matthew 3:13–4:11.
Jesus calls the disciples	Mark 1:14–20; 3:13–19.
Jesus teaches and performs signs	Matthew 5–13; John 2–11.
Peter confesses the Christ	Matthew 16:13–21.

1. The Forerunner and the Birth of Christ

John the Baptist fulfills the messenger prophecies and prepares Israel for the Lord. Jesus is conceived by the Holy Ghost, born of the virgin Mary in Bethlehem, and legally placed in David's house through Joseph.

Prophecy and the Birth Narratives

Promise	Old Testament	Gospel fulfillment
Forerunner	Isaiah 40:3; Malachi 3:1	Matthew 3:1–3; Mark 1:1–4
Virgin-born Immanuel	Isaiah 7:14	Matthew 1:18–25
Born in Bethlehem	Micah 5:2	Matthew 2:1–6; Luke 2:1–7
Son of David	2 Samuel 7:12–16; Isaiah 9:6–7	Matthew 1:1; Luke 1:30–33
Called out of Egypt	Hosea 11:1	Matthew 2:13–15

NOTE — John the Baptist prepared the way of the _____.

NOTE — Jesus was born in the city of _____.

2. The King and the Kingdom

John and Jesus preach that the Kingdom of Heaven is at hand. The message concerns Israel's promised King and Heaven's visible rule on earth. Jesus also teaches the spiritual Kingdom of God, marked by righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost.

Two Kingdom Expressions

Expression	Main emphasis	Key passages
Kingdom of Heaven	Heaven's visible rule on earth through Israel's promised King	Matthew 3:1–2; 4:17; 5–7; 13; Luke 1:30–33
Kingdom of God	God's spiritual rule; righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost	Luke 17:20–21; John 3:3–5; Romans 14:17

NOTE — John and Jesus announced the Kingdom of _____.

NOTE — Romans 14:17 describes the Kingdom of _____ as spiritual.

3. Jesus and His Disciples

Jesus calls twelve disciples, teaches with authority, and performs signs that reveal His identity. He heals sickness, commands nature, casts out devils, feeds multitudes, forgives sins, and raises the dead. As rejection grows, He prepares the disciples for His death and resurrection.

The Twelve Apostles

Group	Names	Key passages
First four	Simon Peter, Andrew, James, John	Matthew 10:2; Mark 1:16–20

Group	Names	Key passages
Next four	Philip, Bartholomew, Thomas, Matthew	Matthew 10:3; John 1:43–51; 20:24–29
Final four	James son of Alphaeus, Lebbaeus / Judas, Simon the Canaanite, Judas Iscariot	Matthew 10:3–4; Luke 6:15–16

NOTE — Jesus chose twelve men whom He named _____.

NOTE — Peter confessed Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. How did John the Baptist prepare Israel?
2. How do the birth narratives connect Jesus with David and Bethlehem?
3. What is the main distinction between the Kingdom of Heaven and the Kingdom of God?
4. What did Jesus' miracles reveal about Him?
5. Why did Jesus begin teaching the disciples about the cross after Peter's confession?

UNIT 6 — JESUS CHRIST, THE PROMISED KING

Lesson 17 — Jesus Christ and the Apostles: Rejection, Cross, Resurrection, and Commission

Lesson Overview: Israel's leaders reject their King, but Christ willingly fulfills God's redemptive purpose. He dies for sins, is buried, rises bodily on the third day, appears to witnesses, commissions the apostles, and ascends with the promise of His return.

MAIN PASSAGES: Psalm 22; Isaiah 52:13–53:12; Matthew 21–28; Luke 22–24; John 18–21; Acts 1:1–11; 1 Corinthians 15:1–28

KEY VERSE | 1 Corinthians 15:3–4 — *Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures; And...he was buried, and...he rose again the third day according to the scriptures:*

READ: Psalm 22; Isaiah 52:13–53:12; Zechariah 9:9; Matthew 21–28; Luke 22–24; John 18–21; Acts 1:1–11; 1 Corinthians 15:1–28.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
The King enters Jerusalem	Matthew 21:1–11; Zechariah 9:9.
Judas betrays Jesus	Matthew 26:14–16, 47–56.
Jesus is tried and condemned	Matthew 26:57–27:26; John 18–19.
Jesus is crucified	Matthew 27; John 19; Psalm 22; Isaiah 53.

Story movement	Scripture
Jesus is buried	Matthew 27:57–66.
Jesus rises bodily	Matthew 28; Luke 24; John 20–21.
Jesus commissions the apostles	Matthew 28:18–20; Luke 24:46–49; Acts 1:8.
Jesus ascends	Acts 1:9–11.

1. The King Is Rejected

Jesus enters Jerusalem as Zechariah's promised King. The leaders plot His death, Judas betrays Him, and Pilate admits that he finds no fault in Him but yields to pressure. Christ willingly lays down His life.

The rejection involves specific leaders, Judas, Roman authority, and a pressured crowd. The Gospel must never be twisted into hatred of Jewish people.

From Jerusalem's Gate to the Cross

Event	People involved	Scripture
Triumphal entry	Jesus, disciples, crowds	Matthew 21:1–11
Final teaching	Jesus, disciples, religious leaders	Matthew 21–25; John 12–17
Last Supper	Jesus and the Twelve	Luke 22:14–20; John 13–17
Arrest	Judas, officers, disciples	Matthew 26:47–56; John 18:1–12
Trials	Jewish council, Pilate, Herod	Matthew 26:57–27:26; Luke 23; John 18–19
Crucifixion	Jesus between two thieves	Matthew 27:27–56; John 19:16–37

NOTE — Jesus entered Jerusalem as the promised _____.

NOTE — Pilate said, ***"I find no _____ in him."***

2. Christ Died, Was Buried, and Rose Again

Christ dies for our sins according to the Scriptures. Joseph of Arimathaea places His body in a known tomb. On the third day the tomb is empty, and Jesus appears bodily to named witnesses.

The Gospel declared in this age is Christ's death for our sins, burial, and resurrection. Salvation is found in Him alone (1 Corinthians 15:1–4; Acts 4:12; Romans 1:16).

Resurrection Witnesses

Witness	Passage
Mary Magdalene and other women	Matthew 28:1–10; John 20:1–18
Two disciples on the Emmaus road	Luke 24:13–35
The gathered disciples	Luke 24:36–49; John 20:19–29
More than five hundred brethren	1 Corinthians 15:6
James, the apostles, and Paul	1 Corinthians 15:7–8

NOTE — Christ died for our sins according to the _____.

NOTE — Jesus rose bodily on the _____ day.

3. The Apostles Are Sent

The risen Christ commands His followers to teach all nations, preach the Gospel to every creature, proclaim repentance and remission of sins, and be witnesses in the Holy Ghost's power. He ascends, and the angels promise that He will return in like manner.

NOTE — Christ commanded the apostles to preach the Gospel to every _____.

NOTE — Jesus ascended to Heaven and will return in like _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. How did the triumphal entry identify Jesus?
2. Who was involved in Christ's rejection and condemnation?
3. What did Christ accomplish at the cross?
4. What evidence supports the bodily resurrection?
5. What did Jesus command the apostles to do?

UNIT 7 — THE CHURCH AND THE COMPLETION OF GOD'S PLAN

Lesson 18 — Peter, Stephen, Philip, and Paul: The Gospel Goes to the Nations

Lesson Overview: The Holy Ghost comes at Pentecost, Peter proclaims the risen Christ, persecution scatters witnesses, Philip preaches in Samaria and to the Ethiopian, and Paul carries the Gospel through the Roman world while churches are established and taught.

MAIN PASSAGES: Acts 1–28; Romans 1:16–17; 1 Corinthians 15:1–4; Ephesians 2–3; Romans 9–11

KEY VERSE | Acts 1:8 — *But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me...unto the uttermost part of the earth.*

READ: Acts 1–2; 4; 6–11; 13–21; 22–28; Romans 1:14–17; 3:21–28; 9–11; 1 Corinthians 12; Ephesians 2–3.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
The Holy Ghost comes	Acts 2.
Peter preaches Christ	Acts 2–5.
Stephen is martyred	Acts 6–7.
Philip preaches in Samaria and to the Ethiopian	Acts 8.

Story movement	Scripture
Saul meets the risen Christ	Acts 9.
Peter enters Cornelius's house	Acts 10–11.
Antioch sends Barnabas and Saul	Acts 13.
Paul's witness reaches Rome	Acts 13–28.

1. Peter and the Jerusalem Witness

At Pentecost the Holy Ghost comes, Peter preaches the crucified and risen Christ, and those who receive the word are baptized and added to the church. Acts 1–7 centers on witness to Israel in Jerusalem and ends with Stephen's rejection and death.

> **Acts 2:42 —** *And they continued stedfastly in the apostles' doctrine and fellowship, and in breaking of bread, and in prayers.*

NOTE — The Holy Ghost came on the day of _____.

NOTE — Acts 1–7 centers on witness in _____.

2. Philip, Peter, and the Gentile Door

Persecution scatters believers into Judaea and Samaria. Philip preaches Christ from Isaiah 53 to the Ethiopian. Peter preaches in Cornelius's house, and Gentiles receive the Word of God.

NOTE — Philip explained Isaiah 53 to the Ethiopian _____.

NOTE — Peter preached Christ in the house of _____.

3. Paul and the Missionary Churches

Saul meets Jesus and becomes Paul, the apostle to the Gentiles. Antioch sends Barnabas and Saul. Paul establishes churches, defends the Gospel, writes Epistles, and witnesses before rulers until Acts ends in Rome.

The Three Main Movements of Acts

Chapters	Main movement	Key people and places
Acts 1–7	Witness to Israel centered in Jerusalem	Peter, John, Stephen; Jerusalem
Acts 8–20	Witness spreads outward; Gentiles receive the Word; churches are established	Philip, Peter, Paul, Barnabas; Samaria, Caesarea, Antioch, Asia, Macedonia, Achaia
Acts 21–28	Paul is arrested, appeals to Caesar, and witnesses toward Rome	Paul; Jerusalem, Caesarea, Malta, Rome

Paul's Missionary Movement

Journey / stage	Main regions	Acts
First journey	Cyprus and southern Galatia	Acts 13–14
Jerusalem council	Jerusalem	Acts 15:1–35
Second journey	Macedonia and Achaia	Acts 15:36–18:22
Third journey	Ephesus, Macedonia, and Greece	Acts 18:23–21:17
To Rome	Arrest, hearings, voyage, and Roman witness	Acts 21:18–28:31

NOTE — The church at _____ sent Barnabas and Saul.

NOTE — Acts ends with Paul preaching in _____.

4. Israel and the Church Remain Distinct

Believing Jews and Gentiles serve Christ together in this age, but the Church does not become Israel or cancel Israel's land, throne, and national-restoration promises. Romans 11 says Israel's present blindness is partial and temporary and that God has not cast away His people.

Israel and the Church in the Story

Question	Israel	Church
Beginning	Abraham, Isaac, Jacob; called out of Egypt as a nation	Promised by Christ; formed after the Holy Ghost came at Pentecost
Identity	The nation descended from Jacob / Israel	Believing Jews and Gentiles serving Christ; expressed through local churches
Primary calling	Literal nation connected with promised land and throne	Heavenly calling with a present Gospel mission among all nations
Present	Partly blinded and set aside nationally, but not cast away	Witnessing, teaching, and serving while waiting for Christ
Future	National turning, regathering, land, and Davidic kingdom	Gathered to Christ before the Tribulation; returns and reigns with Him
Key passages	Genesis 12; 15; 17; 2 Samuel 7; Ezekiel 36–37; Romans 11	Matthew 16:18; Acts 2; Ephesians 2–3; 1 Thessalonians 4

NOTE — God has not cast away His people _____.

NOTE — The Church does not replace _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. What did Peter preach at Pentecost?
2. How did Stephen's death change the movement of Acts?
3. How did Philip and Peter help open the Gentile mission?
4. Trace Paul's witness from Antioch to Rome.
5. How does Romans 11 preserve Israel's future?

UNIT 7 — THE CHURCH AND THE COMPLETION OF GOD'S PLAN

Lesson 19 — John's Revelation: Christ Returns and Makes All Things New

Lesson Overview: John sees the risen Christ, Christ's messages to the churches, the judgments of the Tribulation, the visible return of the King, the thousand-year kingdom, Satan's final defeat, the Great White Throne, and eternity in the new creation.

MAIN PASSAGES: John 14:1–3; 1 Corinthians 15:51–58; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18; Daniel 9:24–27; Revelation 1–22

KEY VERSE | Revelation 21:3 — *Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and he will dwell with them, and they shall be his people…*

READ: John 14:1–3; 1 Corinthians 3:11–15; 15:51–58; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–5:11; Daniel 9:24–27; Revelation 1–3; 6–22; 2 Peter 3:10–13.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
John sees the risen Christ	Revelation 1.
Christ addresses seven churches	Revelation 2–3.
Christ gathers His Church	John 14:1–3; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18.
Tribulation judgments unfold	Daniel 9:24–27; Revelation 6–18.

Story movement	Scripture
Christ returns as King	Revelation 19:11–21.
Christ reigns one thousand years	Revelation 20:1–6.
Satan is defeated and the dead are judged	Revelation 20:7–15.
God makes all things new	Revelation 21–22.

1. Christ and the Churches

John sees Jesus Christ glorified and hears His messages to seven literal churches. Their order also presents a broad spiritual course from early zeal through persecution, compromise, reform, missionary opportunity, and final lukewarmness.

The Seven Churches of Revelation 2–3

Church	Christ's main message	Spiritual picture
Ephesus	Sound labor, but first love left	Early strength with declining love
Smyrna	Faithful through suffering	Persecuted church
Pergamos	Faithfulness mixed with false doctrine	Worldly alliance and compromise
Thyatira	Service mixed with deep corruption	Growing religious corruption
Sardis	A name to live, but spiritually dead	Formal profession needing revival

Church	Christ's main message	Spiritual picture
Philadelphia	An open door and faithful Word	Missionary opportunity and faithfulness
Laodicea	Lukewarm, self-satisfied, and poor	Final apostasy and self-sufficiency

NOTE — John received the Revelation on the isle of _____.

NOTE — Laodicea is described as _____.

2. The Rapture, Judgment Seat, and Tribulation

Christ will descend into the air, the dead in Christ will rise, and living believers will be caught up to meet Him. This comes before the Tribulation and is distinct from Christ's public return. Believers' service is evaluated at the judgment seat of Christ.

Daniel's seventieth week concerns Daniel's people and holy city. During the Tribulation the Antichrist rises, judgment falls, and Israel is brought through trouble toward national repentance.

The Rapture and Second Coming Distinguished

Question	Rapture	Second Coming
Christ's movement	Believers meet Christ in the air	Christ returns openly to earth
People emphasized	Dead in Christ and living believers	Israel and the nations; saints return with Christ
Purpose	Gather the Church to Christ	Judge enemies, deliver Israel, establish the kingdom
Timing	Before the Tribulation	After the Tribulation

Question	Rapture	Second Coming
Passages	John 14:1–3; 1 Corinthians 15:51–58; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18	Zechariah 12–14; Matthew 24:29–31; Revelation 19:11–21

NOTE — Believers will be caught up to meet the Lord in the _____.

NOTE — Daniel's seventieth week concerns his people and holy _____.

3. The King Returns and Reigns

Jesus Christ returns visibly as King of kings, defeats His enemies, delivers Israel's believing remnant, and establishes the promised Davidic kingdom. Satan is bound while Christ reigns for one thousand years.

After the thousand years Satan leads a final rebellion and is cast into the lake of fire. The Great White Throne follows, where the unsaved dead are judged.

From Christ's Return to Final Judgment

Event	What happens	Scripture
Second Coming	Christ returns openly as King of kings	Revelation 19:11–21
Satan bound	The deceiver is confined for one thousand years	Revelation 20:1–3
Millennium	Christ reigns; Israel's kingdom promises are fulfilled	Isaiah 11; Ezekiel 36–37; Revelation 20:4–6
Final rebellion	Satan is released and leads one last revolt	Revelation 20:7–10
Great White Throne	The unsaved dead are judged according to the books	Revelation 20:11–15

NOTE — Christ will reign on earth for one thousand _____.

NOTE — The unsaved dead stand before the Great White _____.

4. New Creation and Eternity

God reveals a new heaven and new earth. New Jerusalem descends; the curse is gone; God's servants see His face, serve Him, and reign for ever. The story that began with rebellion, darkness, and a lost garden ends with Christ victorious and God dwelling with His people.

Revelation 22:20 — *Surely I come quickly. Amen. Even so, come, Lord Jesus.*

The Bible Story Completed

Beginning	Completion	Scripture
Heaven and earth created	New heaven and new earth	Genesis 1:1; Revelation 21:1
Darkness and rebellion	No night and no more rebellion	Genesis 1:2; Revelation 21:23–27; 22:5
Tree of life guarded	Tree of life freely available	Genesis 3:22–24; Revelation 22:2, 14
Curse enters	No more curse	Genesis 3:14–19; Revelation 22:3
Man driven from God's presence	God dwells with His people	Genesis 3:23–24; Revelation 21:3
Serpent promised defeat	Satan in the lake of fire	Genesis 3:15; Revelation 20:10

NOTE — In the new creation there will be no more _____.

NOTE — God's servants will see His face and reign for ever and _____.

Check Your Understanding

1. What do Christ's messages to the seven churches teach?
2. How is the Rapture distinct from the Second Coming?
3. How do Daniel 9 and Revelation describe the Tribulation?
4. What happens during and after the thousand-year kingdom?
5. How do Revelation 21–22 complete the story begun in Genesis?

REFERENCE APPENDIX

Appendix A — The Sixty-Six Books and Their Place in the Story

Each book belongs to a major division and contributes to the Bible's connected history.

Division	Book	Role in the story
Law	Genesis	Beginnings; patriarchs; covenant promise
Law	Exodus	Israel redeemed from Egypt and formed as a nation
Law	Leviticus	Holiness, priesthood, sacrifices, worship
Law	Numbers	Wilderness testing and the new generation
Law	Deuteronomy	Covenant instruction renewed before Canaan
History	Joshua	Conquest and distribution of the land
History	Judges	Cycles of apostasy, oppression, and deliverance
History	Ruth	Kinsman redemption and David's family line
History	1 Samuel	Samuel, Saul, and David's rise
History	2 Samuel	David's reign and covenant
History	1 Kings	Solomon and the divided kingdom begins
History	2 Kings	Both kingdoms decline and go into exile
History	1 Chronicles	Genealogies and David with temple emphasis
History	2 Chronicles	Solomon and Judah with temple emphasis
History	Ezra	Return and rebuilding of the temple
History	Nehemiah	Jerusalem's walls and covenant renewal

Division	Book	Role in the story
History	Esther	Providential preservation in Persia
Poetry/Wisdom	Job	Suffering, human limits, and God's wisdom
Poetry/Wisdom	Psalms	Inspired worship, prayer, and Messianic hope
Poetry/Wisdom	Proverbs	Wisdom under the fear of the LORD
Poetry/Wisdom	Ecclesiastes	Life under the sun and the whole duty of man
Poetry/Wisdom	Song of Solomon	Covenant love in marriage poetry
Major Prophets	Isaiah	Judgment, comfort, Servant, and Messianic King
Major Prophets	Jeremiah	Judah's last days and new-covenant promise
Major Prophets	Lamentations	Mourning Jerusalem's destruction
Major Prophets	Ezekiel	Glory, exile, new heart, restoration, temple
Major Prophets	Daniel	Faithful witness and the course of kingdoms
Minor Prophets	Hosea	Israel's unfaithfulness and God's covenant love
Minor Prophets	Joel	The day of the LORD and promised Spirit
Minor Prophets	Amos	Justice, judgment, and Davidic restoration
Minor Prophets	Obadiah	Edom judged; the kingdom belongs to the LORD
Minor Prophets	Jonah	God's mercy to Nineveh and a reluctant prophet
Minor Prophets	Micah	Judgment, Bethlehem's ruler, and restoration
Minor Prophets	Nahum	Nineveh's final judgment
Minor Prophets	Habakkuk	Questions, faith, and God's sovereign justice
Minor Prophets	Zephaniah	The day of the LORD and a restored remnant

Division	Book	Role in the story
Minor Prophets	Haggai	Rebuild the temple; future glory
Minor Prophets	Zechariah	Visions, the Branch, the pierced King, the kingdom
Minor Prophets	Malachi	Corrupt worship and the coming messenger
Gospels	Matthew	Jesus the Messiah and King
Gospels	Mark	Jesus the authoritative Servant
Gospels	Luke	Jesus the perfect Son of man and Saviour
Gospels	John	Jesus the divine Son who gives life
History	Acts	The Spirit-empowered witness from Jerusalem to Rome
Epistles	Romans	The gospel, justification, sanctification, Israel
Epistles	1 Corinthians	Church correction, gifts, resurrection
Epistles	2 Corinthians	Ministry, weakness, comfort, giving
Epistles	Galatians	Justification by faith apart from the Law
Epistles	Ephesians	The Church in Christ and one new body
Epistles	Philippians	Joy, humility, and Christ-centered living
Epistles	Colossians	The supremacy and sufficiency of Christ
Epistles	1 Thessalonians	A model church and Christ's return
Epistles	2 Thessalonians	The day of the Lord and steadfastness
Epistles	1 Timothy	Doctrine, leadership, and church order
Epistles	2 Timothy	Guard and pass on the Word

Division	Book	Role in the story
Epistles	Titus	Sound doctrine and good works
Epistles	Philemon	Gospel reconciliation in a personal case
General Epistles	Hebrews	Christ better than the old-covenant shadows
General Epistles	James	Living faith shown through works
General Epistles	1 Peter	Hope and holiness in suffering
General Epistles	2 Peter	Growth, Scripture, false teachers, coming day
General Epistles	1 John	Assurance, truth, obedience, and love
General Epistles	2 John	Truth and love with discernment
General Epistles	3 John	Faithful hospitality and harmful ambition
General Epistles	Jude	Contend for the faith against apostasy
General Epistles	Revelation	Christ's victory, judgment, kingdom, and new creation

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Appendix B — Key Bible-Story Terms

Read each term according to its immediate biblical context.

Term	Definition
Covenant	A binding promise or agreement established by God; always identify its parties and terms.
Dispensation / stewardship	An order of responsibility entrusted by God for a particular period (Ephesians 3:2; Colossians 1:25).
Gentile	A person or nation outside Israel.
Hebrew	A name first used of Abram and later of his descendants.
Israel	Jacob's God-given name and the name of the nation descended from him; after the split it can also mean the northern kingdom.
Jew	A name connected with Judah and commonly used for Israel's people after the exile and in the New Testament.
Church	An assembly belonging to Christ; Acts and the Epistles show local churches carrying out His commands.
Kingdom of Heaven	Heaven's visible rule on earth through Israel's promised King.
Kingdom of God	God's spiritual rule, marked by righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost.
Day of the LORD / Day of Jesus Christ	The Day of the LORD concerns God's intervention in judgment and Christ's public return; the Day of Jesus Christ concerns Christ's gathering of believers and the completion of His work in the Church.

Term	Definition
Messiah / Christ	The Anointed One promised in the Old Testament and revealed as Jesus.
Gospel	The good news that Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again the third day (1 Corinthians 15:1–4).
Rapture	Christ's gathering of the dead in Christ and living believers to meet Him in the air.
Tribulation	Daniel's final week and the time of judgment preceding Christ's public return.
Second Coming	Christ's visible return to earth as King of kings.
Millennium	Christ's literal thousand-year reign described in Revelation 20.

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Appendix C — Kings and Prophets Master Reference

Kings and prophets belong to the same history. These tables connect the rulers, prophetic ministries, and national outcomes.

Northern Kingdom — Selected Kings and Prophets

Period	Selected kings	Prophets and message	Outcome / study
First dynasty	Jeroboam I, Nadab	A man of God condemns the altar	Counterfeit worship begins (1 Kings 12–14)
Baasha to Omri	Baasha, Elah, Zimri, Omri	Jehu son of Hanani warns Baasha	Dynasties change through violence (1 Kings 15–16)
House of Omri	Ahab, Ahaziah, Joram	Elijah and Elisha confront Baal	Drought, Carmel, signs, judgment (1 Kings 17–2 Kings 9)
House of Jehu	Jehu, Jehoahaz, Joash, Jeroboam II	Jonah, Amos, Hosea	Temporary strength; deep corruption (2 Kings 10–14)
Final years	Zechariah, Shallum, Menahem, Pekahiah, Pekah, Hoshea	Warnings continue, but Israel will not hear	Samaria falls to Assyria (2 Kings 15–17)

Southern Kingdom — Selected Kings and Prophets

Period	Selected rulers	Prophets and message	Outcome / study
Early kingdom	Rehoboam, Abijah, Asa, Jehoshaphat	Shemaiah, Azariah, Hanani, Jehu	Compromise and reform (2 Chronicles 10–20)
Athaliah crisis	Jehoram, Ahaziah, Athaliah, Joash	Elijah's letter; Jehoiada and Zechariah	David's line preserved (2 Chronicles 21–24)
Assyrian era	Amaziah, Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, Hezekiah	Isaiah, Micah, Hosea	Jerusalem delivered from Assyria (2 Kings 18–20)
Final reform	Manasseh, Amon, Josiah	Nahum, Zephaniah, Jeremiah	Josiah responds to the Law (2 Kings 21–23)
Final kings	Jehoahaz, Jehoiakim, Jehoiachin, Zedekiah	Jeremiah, Habakkuk, Ezekiel	Jerusalem falls to Babylon (2 Kings 24–25)

Prophets in their historical settings

Period	Audience	Prophets	Primary emphasis
Divided kingdom—early	Judah/Israel	Shemaiah, Ahijah, Hanani, Jehu son of Hanani	Division, covenant warning, royal accountability
Ahab/Omri dynasty	Israel	Elijah, Micaiah, Elisha	Baal confronted; the LORD alone is God
Jeroboam II and after	Israel	Jonah, Amos, Hosea	Prosperity cannot hide injustice and apostasy
Assyrian crisis	Judah	Isaiah, Micah	Trust the LORD; judgment and Messianic hope

Period	Audience	Prophets	Primary emphasis
Josiah/final kings	Judah	Zephaniah, Habakkuk, Jeremiah, Huldah	Day of the LORD; Babylon coming; return promised
Babylonian exile	Exiles/ Gentile courts	Ezekiel, Daniel	Glory, responsibility, empires, restoration
Return and rebuilding	Returned community	Haggai, Zechariah	Rebuild; the Branch and coming King
Post-exilic decline	Judah	Malachi	Pure worship; coming messenger and Lord

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Appendix D — Selected Messianic Prophecies and Fulfillments

These Old Testament promises are paired with their New Testament fulfillment or inspired explanation. Some passages also include future kingdom elements beyond Christ's first coming.

Promise	Old Testament	New Testament	Significance
Seed of the woman	Genesis 3:15	Galatians 4:4; Hebrews 2:14	Human birth and victory over the serpent
Blessing through Abraham's seed	Genesis 12:3; 22:18	Galatians 3:8, 16	Gospel blessing reaches the nations
Ruler from Judah	Genesis 49:10	Luke 3:33; Revelation 5:5	Messiah comes from Judah
Prophet like Moses	Deuteronomy 18:15–18	Acts 3:20–23	Authoritative Prophet must be heard
Son and throne of David	2 Samuel 7:12–16	Luke 1:32–33	Everlasting Davidic King
Resurrection / no corruption	Psalm 16:10	Acts 2:25–32; 13:35–37	Christ rises from the dead
Suffering described	Psalm 22	Matthew 27; John 19	Mocking, pierced suffering, garments divided
Virgin-born Immanuel	Isaiah 7:14	Matthew 1:22–23	God with us

Promise	Old Testament	New Testament	Significance
Divine Davidic ruler	Isaiah 9:6–7	Luke 1:32–35	Son given; everlasting government
Forerunner's voice	Isaiah 40:3	Matthew 3:1–3	John prepares the Lord's way
Sin-bearing Servant	Isaiah 52:13–53:12	Acts 8:30–35; 1 Peter 2:24	Substitution, death, burial, vindication
New covenant	Jeremiah 31:31–34	Luke 22:20; Hebrews 8	Promised to Israel and Judah; ratified by Christ's blood
Ruler born in Bethlehem	Micah 5:2	Matthew 2:5–6	David's city and ancient goings forth
Humble King enters Jerusalem	Zechariah 9:9	Matthew 21:4–9	Royal entry on an ass
Pierced One	Zechariah 12:10	John 19:37; Revelation 1:7	Piercing and future recognition
Coming messenger	Malachi 3:1; 4:5–6	Luke 1:16–17; Mark 1:2–4	John ministers in Elijah's spirit and power